Alarm Panel



Category: **Safety & PPE** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Alarm Panels

What it is used for

An alarm panel monitors connected sensors and activates audible or visual alerts when a fire, intrusion, gas leak, or other monitored condition is detected. Operate and test the panel according to the installed system's instructions so that alarms remain reliable and emergency signals are not accidentally disabled.

Main parts

- Control panel and display
- Status indicators and control buttons
- Power supply and backup battery
- Connected sensors and detector circuits
- Alarm sounders, beacons, or notification outputs
- Communication module and event log, if fitted

Before you start

1. Confirm the alarm system type, monitored zones, and authorised operating procedure.
2. Check the panel enclosure, display, indicators, and visible wiring for damage.
3. Verify that mains power and backup battery indicators show normal status.
4. Review any active faults, alarms, or disabled zones before testing.
5. Notify the responsible person and affected occupants before a planned alarm test.
6. Confirm that the test will not interfere with emergency response or other safety systems.

How to use

1. Approach the panel and check its displayed status and indicator lights.
2. Authenticate using the authorised access method if the system requires it.
3. Review active alarms, faults, and zone information on the display.
4. For a test, select the approved test mode or procedure specified by the manufacturer.
5. Test only the designated sensors, alarm sounders, indicators, or communication functions as authorised.
6. Confirm that expected audible, visual, and panel indications occur during the test.
7. Check that the event log records the test or event correctly, where supported.
8. Investigate any fault indication using the approved troubleshooting procedure.
9. Do not bypass a sensor or disable a zone unless authorised and required by the approved procedure.
10. Restore the system to its normal monitoring state after testing.

1. Confirm that all required zones and alarm outputs are enabled and that no unresolved fault remains.
2. Record the test results, faults, corrective actions, and any temporary impairment; notify the responsible person.

⚠ Safety

- Only authorised and trained personnel should change settings, isolate zones, or reset protected systems.
- Never ignore a genuine alarm or assume it is a test without confirmation.
- Follow the site's emergency plan and evacuate when required.
- Do not disconnect power, remove batteries, or open electrical compartments unless authorised and safe to do so.
- If a safety-critical alarm system is impaired, notify the responsible person immediately and implement approved temporary safeguards.
- Do not reset or silence an alarm until the cause has been assessed and the site's procedure permits it.

Care & storage

- Inspect the panel enclosure, indicators, labels, and accessible cables regularly.
- Test backup batteries and alarm functions at the intervals specified by the manufacturer and applicable requirements.
- Keep the panel clean, dry, unobstructed, and accessible to authorised responders.
- Review event logs and resolve recurring faults promptly.
- Arrange qualified servicing for wiring faults, battery failures, or persistent system errors.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Silencing or resetting an alarm before checking its cause.
- Leaving a zone disabled after maintenance or testing.
- Ignoring fault indicators or a low backup-battery warning.
- Conducting an alarm test without notifying affected people or coordinating emergency monitoring.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

Prepared by - Subodh Kumar